

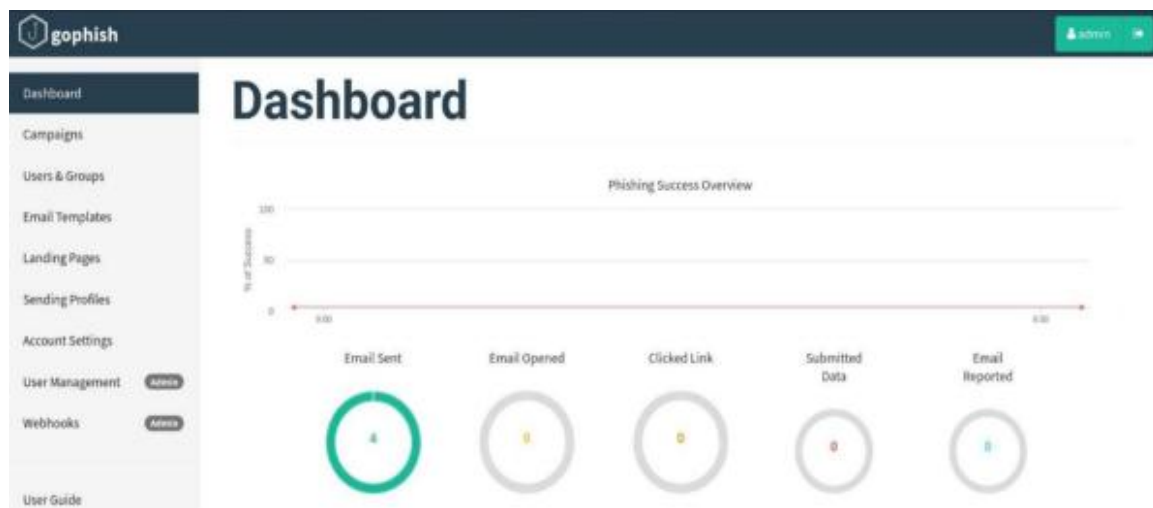
Gophish Simulated Phishing Campaign Report

1. Introduction

Gophish is a versatile open-source phishing simulation toolkit used by cybersecurity teams to conduct controlled phishing exercises. The tool helps organizations design, launch, and track phishing campaigns to test employee awareness about phishing attacks. It can simulate real-world scenarios by sending convincing emails and monitoring user responses such as email openings, link clicks, and form submissions. Through these insights, companies can strengthen their defenses and reduce risks caused by human error.

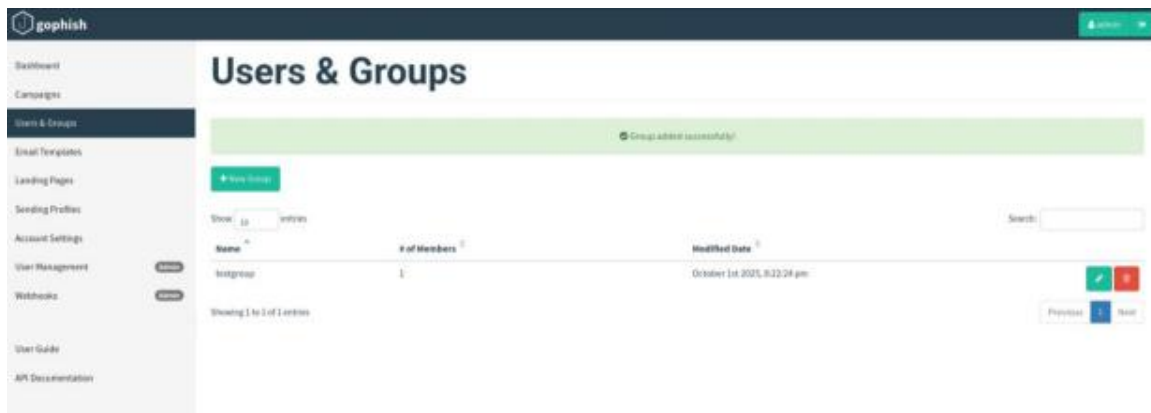
2. Environment Setup and Access

The Gophish tool was installed and executed within a Kali Linux virtual environment to ensure a safe and isolated setup. After installation, the Gophish dashboard was accessed through a browser interface. This dashboard allows users to manage every aspect of the campaign including creating groups, templates, landing pages, and tracking outcomes. The tool provided detailed real-time statistics on each campaign, making it easy to visualize user behavior and campaign success rates.



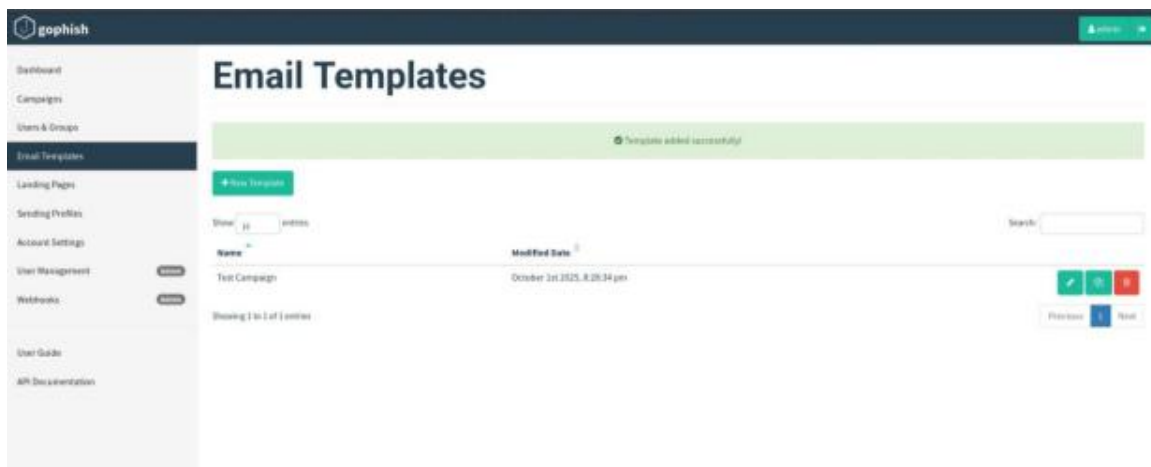
3. User Groups Creation

A specific test group was created under the 'Users & Groups' section, representing employees who would receive the phishing emails. Each user entry included details like name and email address. By categorizing users into groups, it becomes easier to organize and target campaigns based on departments or awareness levels. This step ensured that the simulation accurately represented a realistic attack targeting a specific segment.



4. Designing Email Templates

In the 'Email Templates' section, a phishing email was drafted to look professional and urgent. It mimicked an internal IT alert requesting immediate password verification. Such an approach increases the likelihood that users will engage with the message. Visual elements such as company logos, professional fonts, and action links were added to make the email appear authentic and credible.



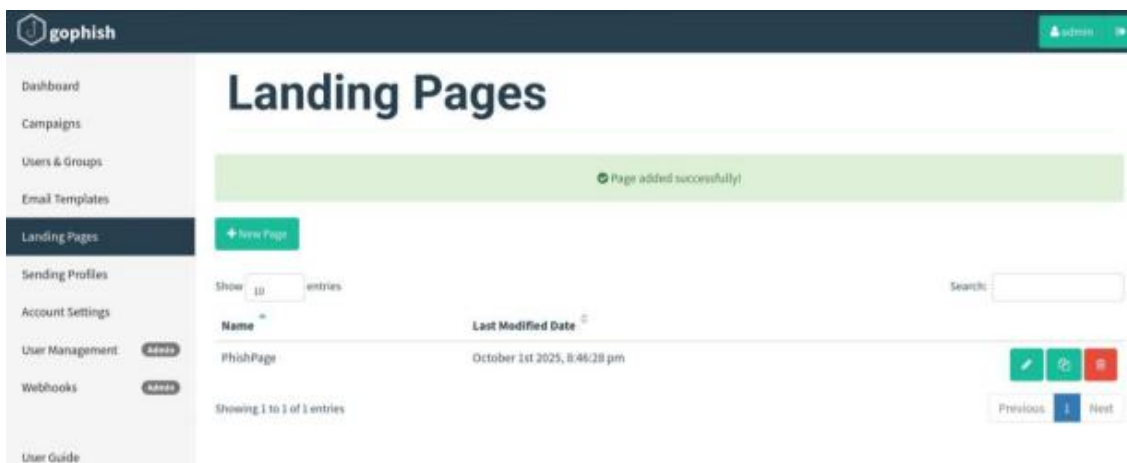
5. Configuring the Sending Profile

The sending profile determines how and from where the phishing emails are sent. Using SMTP configurations, a profile was created to make emails appear as though they came from a trusted organizational domain. This enhanced the realism of the attack and helped evaluate how users respond when emails seem to come from internal sources. Testing the SMTP setup ensured that all messages were successfully delivered to the target users.



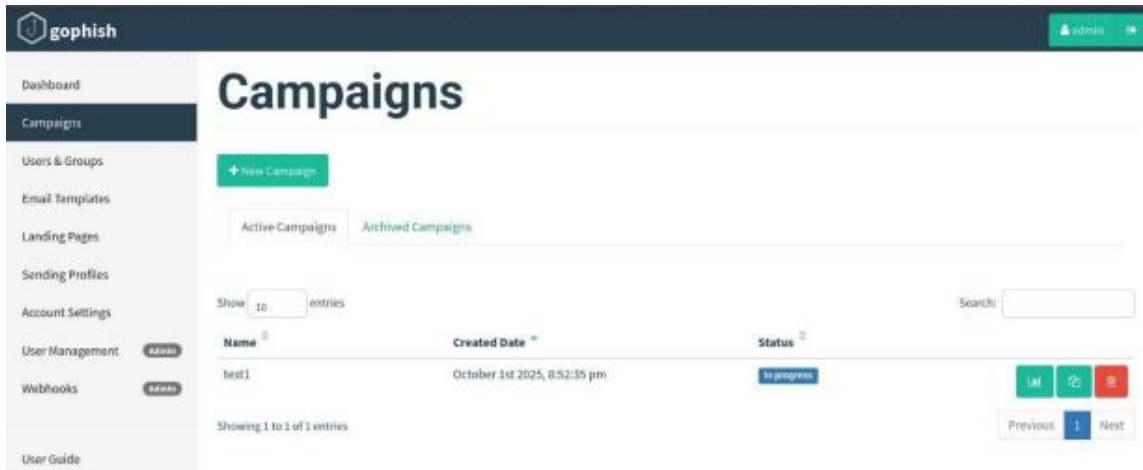
6. Creating the Landing Page

A custom landing page was designed using Gophish's built-in editor. This page simulated a secure login portal where users were asked to enter their credentials after clicking the phishing link. The purpose was to capture and record submissions safely within the controlled environment. The landing page also displayed professional styling and company logos to make it believable. No real credentials were collected — this was purely for educational and assessment purposes.



7. Campaign Execution and Monitoring

After all configurations were complete, the phishing campaign was launched. The dashboard provided live updates showing how many users opened the emails, clicked the links, and submitted their information. These metrics were analyzed to understand the overall susceptibility rate among participants. Additionally, the Gophish dashboard displayed timelines and response graphs that helped identify the most vulnerable points in the workflow.



8. Results and Observations

The results revealed that a significant portion of users interacted with the phishing email, highlighting a gap in phishing awareness. However, many users refrained from entering credentials after realizing the suspicious nature of the request, indicating partial awareness. These observations underscore the need for continuous education and periodic phishing simulations to enhance user vigilance.

9. Conclusion

The Gophish simulation successfully demonstrated how phishing attacks operate from creation to user interaction. It offered valuable insight into both technical and human vulnerabilities within an organization. The experiment emphasized the importance of proactive awareness programs and regular phishing simulations to create a robust cybersecurity culture. By identifying weaknesses before real attackers do, the organization can strengthen its defenses and protect sensitive information.